

Parking lot USB exercise

Contents	<i>The USB contains Personally Identifiable Information (names, wedding dates financial details)</i> <i>Work related document are contained the device which ordinarily ought to be separate from personal details</i> <i>As a resource manager details in the USB drive may also include informations of colleagues</i>
Attacker mindset	<i>This information the USB drive can serve as an initial reconnaissance step to social engineering in the hands of a malicious threat actor</i> <i>The drive could be a bait designed to get someone to plug it in, which then installs sophisticated malware or spyware on their system, giving the attacker a foothold in the hospital's network.</i>
Risk analysis	Malicious Code Execution <i>The Risk: This is the most immediate technical threat. Malicious code could be hidden on the device. When plugged into a computer, it could automatically execute, take over the system, and spread through the connected network. In a hospital environment, this is especially dangerous as it could compromise critical patient care systems.</i> <i>Remediation: We must disable auto-run features on all workstations and ensure robust endpoint protection is active. Most importantly, clear policies must forbid plugging in unknown drives, backed up by regular staff training.</i> Identity Exploitation <i>The Risk: If sensitive information like subscription details or financial data gets into the wrong hands, an attacker can use it to impersonate the owner or even incriminate them. An attacker could use financial details to make unauthorized transactions or access systems they shouldn't, making it look like the legitimate user did it.</i> <i>Remediation: Sensitive data should never be stored on</i>

unencrypted removable drives. We need to enforce strict data handling policies, encrypt files at rest, and monitor for any unusual access patterns to catch misuse early.

Social Engineering Through Brand Trust

The Risk: The USB has the hospital's logo on it, which immediately makes it look legitimate. An attacker could use this as a pretext to gain employees' trust, tricking them into plugging it into their workstations. People see the company logo, assume the device belongs to a colleague, and lower their guard.

Remediation: This comes down to training and culture. We need to run regular security awareness sessions that cover physical threats like USB drops, and establish a simple, unbreakable rule: If you find a drive, hand it to IT do not plug it in.